PASSING SKILLS:

Key:

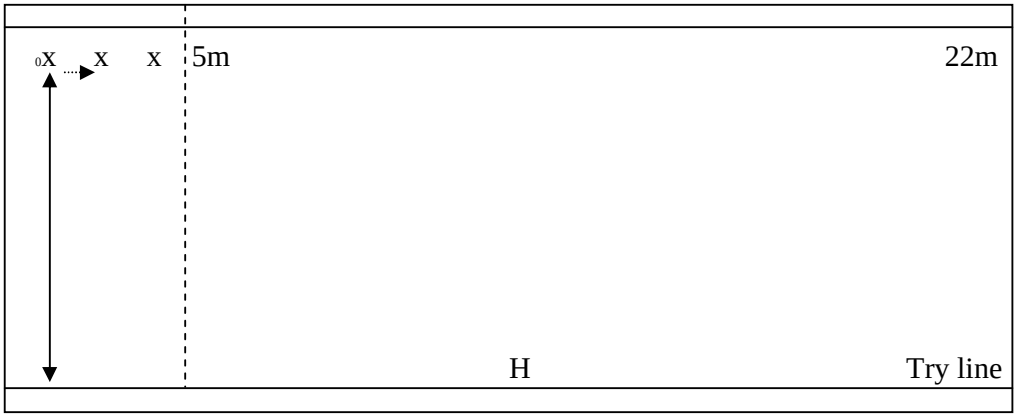
X = Player	= Pass	= Change of pace (Sprint)
D = Defender	S = Shield	
A = Attacker	T = Tackle Bag	
0 = Ball	H = Rugby Poles	
= Run	* = Cone	

Passing: General Tips

- Hands out (fingers up)
- Turn shoulders / hips to receive pass
- Pass with relaxed shoulders and arms, hands and fingers
- Arms should never be stiff (slight elbow bend helps relax arms)
- For more accuracy, swing the ball in a plane that is more vertical than horizontal
- Don't loop arms whilst passing (catch and pass in one action)
- The most important thing when passing is your eyes (look / aim), keep them open and watch the ball

Drill 1: Passing Skills

Group: 5 of 3 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 0

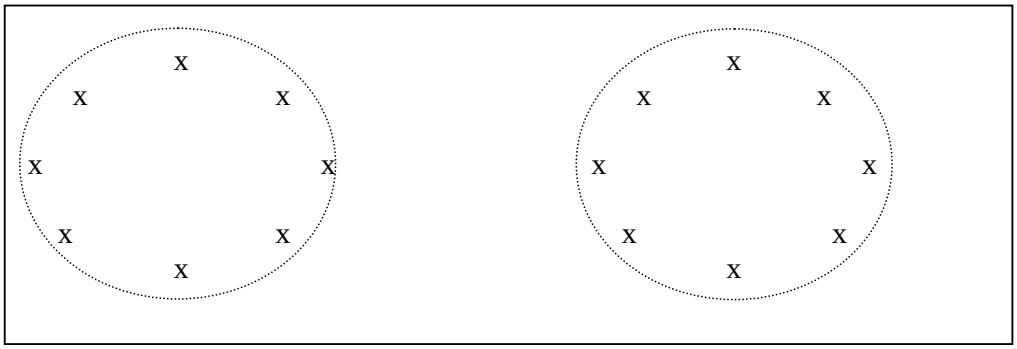


1. Normal passing
2. Passing behind the back
3. Over the shoulder
4. Under the leg
5. Scissors (player running off must straighten)

Coaching Tip: Put the players under pressure by making the outlines 'Electric fences' i.e. players forbidden to run out.

Drill 2: Passing Wheel

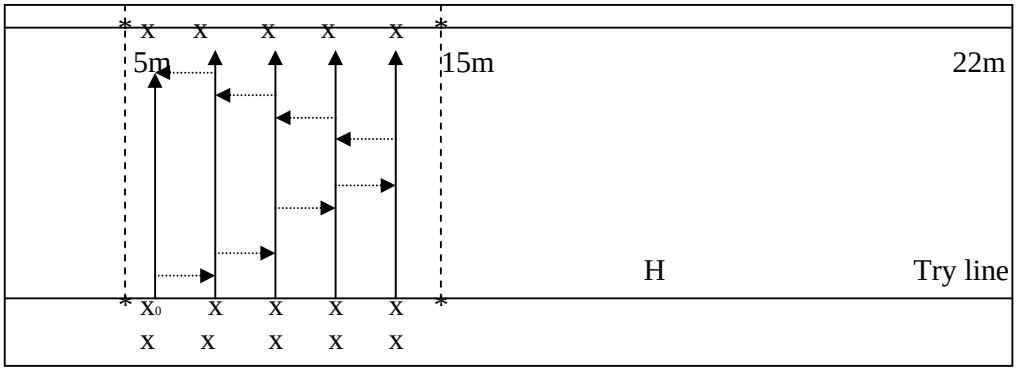
Group: 2 of 8 **Balls:** 2 **Cones:** 0



Passing is done outside the circle (players face outwards).
Get both teams to compete against each other.
Variation: Players can do a push up after passing or introduce a second ball.

Drill 3: Relay Passing

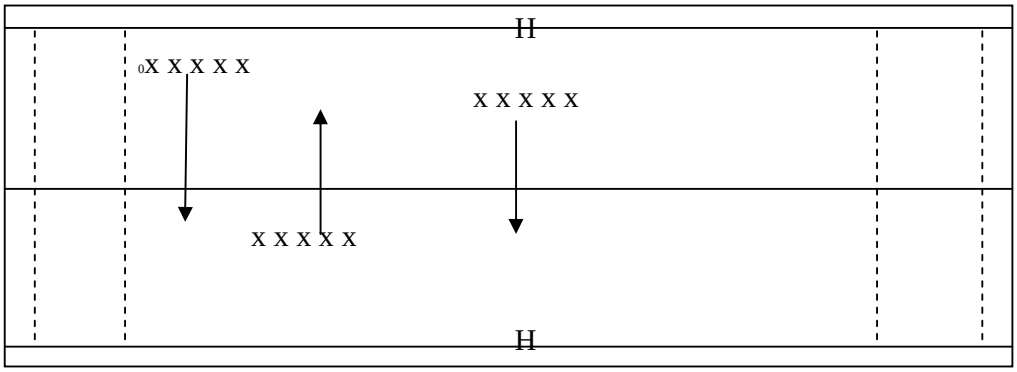
Group: 3 of 5 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 4



Depending on the players skill levels they may be able to pass back down the line before reaching the other end.
Coaching Tip: Remember to look for the correct passing technique.
Variation: Skip, skip and reverse, Scissors on the outside etc.

Drill 4: Continuous Passing

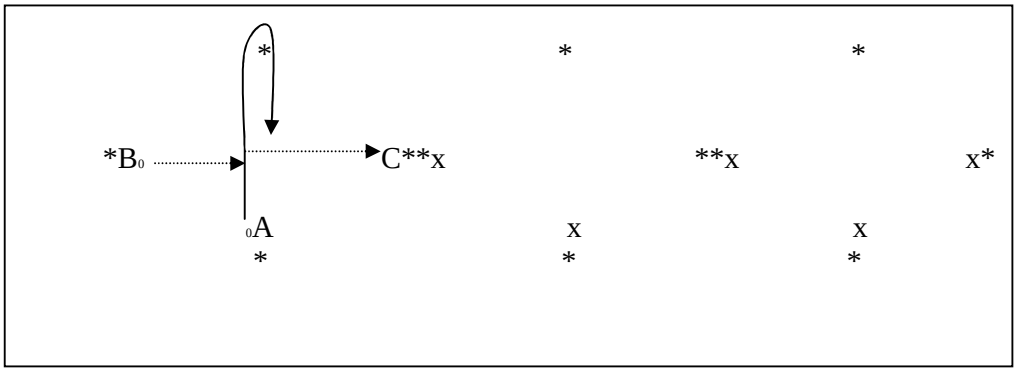
Group: 3 of 5 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 0



Groups pass the ball through the hands with the last player putting the ball down on the ground for the next group to realign and pass.
It is a continuous exercise making use of the whole field.
Variation: Starter moves / moves, etc. can be used.

Drill 5: Quick Hands

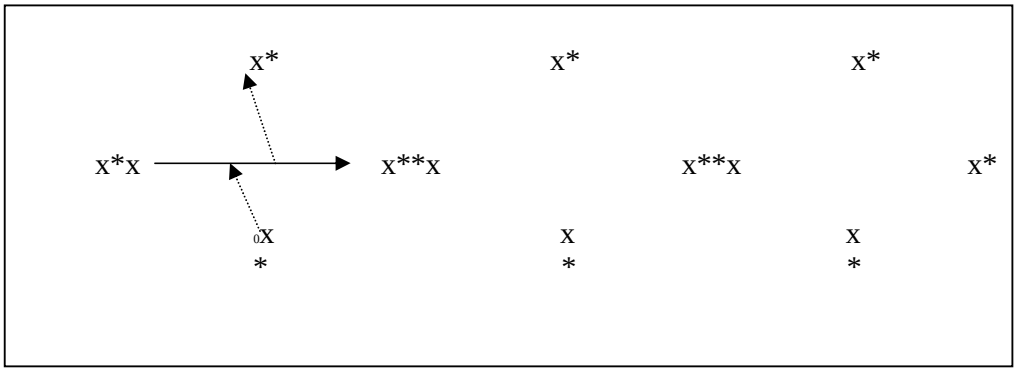
Group: 5 of 3 **Balls:** 10 **Cones:** 20



A has a ball he runs towards the cone when he get to the middle he throws his ball into the air while receiving another ball from player B. A passes to C catches the ball that is in the air runs around the cone and repeats.
Coaching Tip: Great drill for sharpening up reaction time, peripheral vision and developing ball skills. Depending on the skill levels, it may take a while for players to get it right.
Variation: Instead of throwing the ball into the air the player can roll it etc.

Drill 6: Quick Hands Triangle

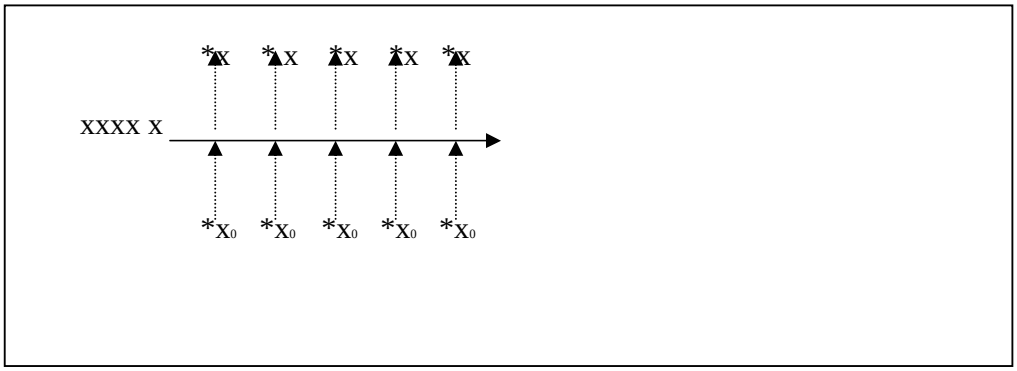
Group: 3 of 5 **Balls:** 3 **Cones:** 12



Players demonstrate quick hands. The small group sizes force the players to be moving all the time. This also increases the number of passes each player makes.
Variation: Make the groups bigger. Replace the players on the outside with two scrumhalfs. They roll the ball forward on the ground before picking it up and passing.

Drill 7: Pressure Pass (Catch and Pass)

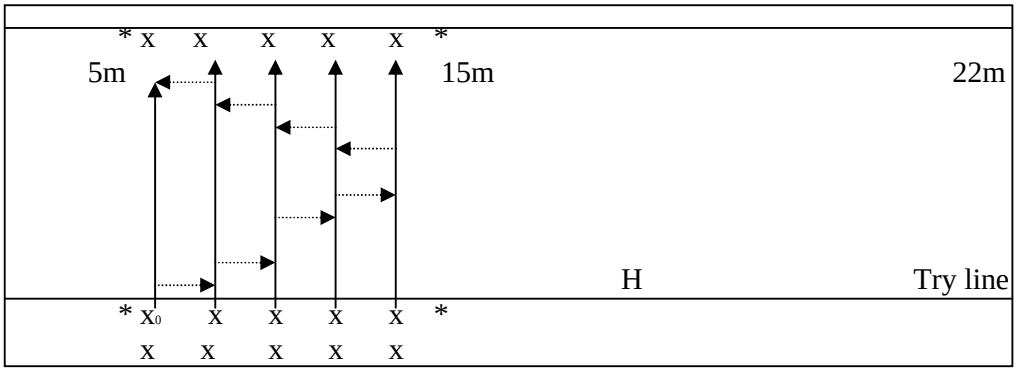
Group: 3 of 5 **Balls:** 5 **Cones:** 10



This drill puts the players under a lot of pressure. Players need to have quick hands. Once all the players from the passing group have gone through they return from the opposite end. Keep rotating the groups.
Coaching Tip: Depending on the level of skill the distance of the pass and the distance before the next pass can be adjusted accordingly.

Drill 8: Quick Hands – Fast Feet

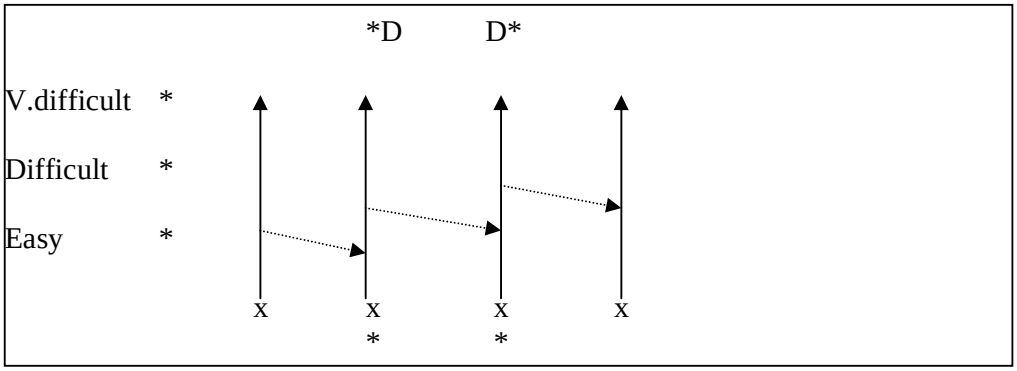
Group: 3 of 5 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 4



This drill must be done with fast feet and soft hands. Players mustn't fall away after passing and their hips mustn't turn with the pass.
Coaching Tip: Players must pass softly but quickly. Forward lean, body relaxed, and hips facing the direction they are running. This is an advanced drill. Players seem to battle with it.

Drill 9: Quick Hands – with Defenders

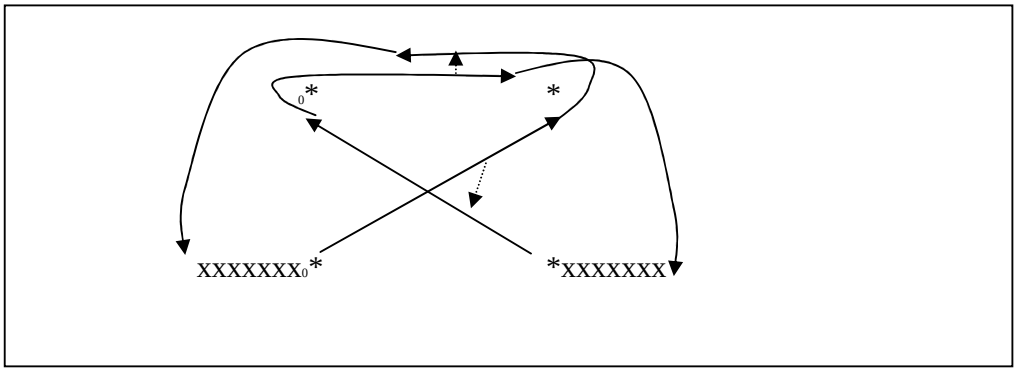
Group: 1 of 6 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 10



When the first attacking player reaches the 'easy cone' he passes. This is also the cue for the defenders to move forward. No contact. As the players get better you can change the difficulty level by passing later i.e. having the defenders closer.

Drill 10: Cross over Grid

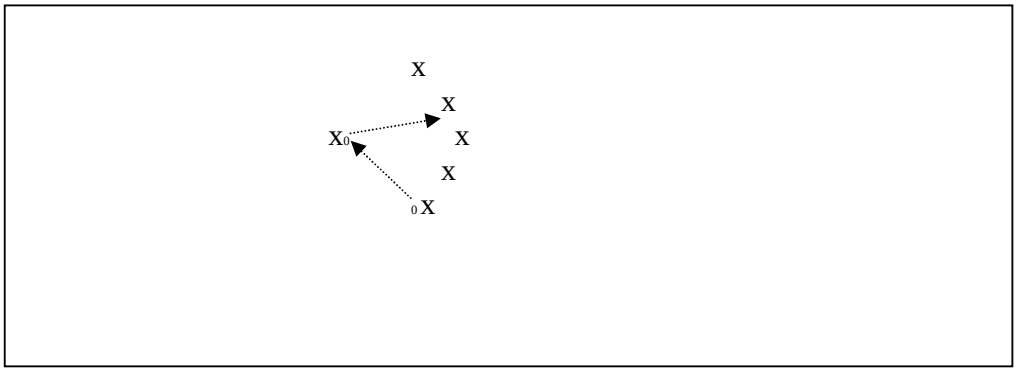
Group: 2 of 8 **Balls:** 2 **Cones:** 4



This drill looks a lot worse than what it is. The players first do a switch followed by short pass once they have run around the cones. The drill starts with the first player holding a ball. He does a switch with the first player from the other group who then switches with the next player from the first group. He then picks up the second ball while running around the cone, passes / pops to the first player who pops / passes to the next player etc.

Drill 11: Hands and Vision

Group: 1 of 6 **Balls:** 2 **Cones:** 0

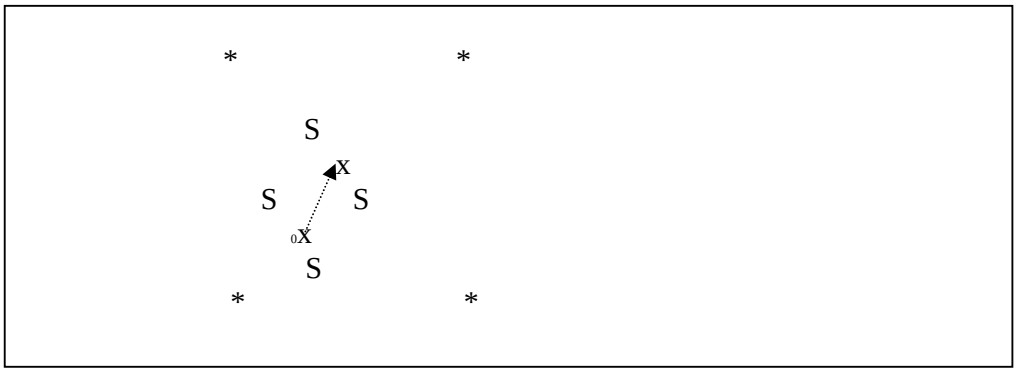


Players form an arc around a player. The player in the arc has a ball and the other ball is with another player who has formed part of the arc. On the signal the balls are passed.

Coaching Tip: Players need to communicate and get the timing right.

Drill 12: Ten Pass

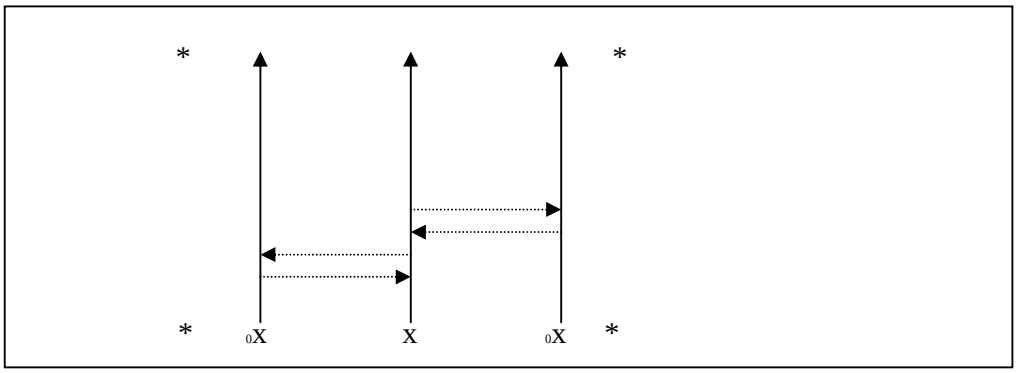
Group: 1 of 6 **Balls:** 2 **Cones:** 0



Ball can be passed in any direction. The attacking pair needs to avoid contact and pass as many times as possible in a minute. No overhead passing allowed.

Drill 13: Quick Hands and Peripheral Vision

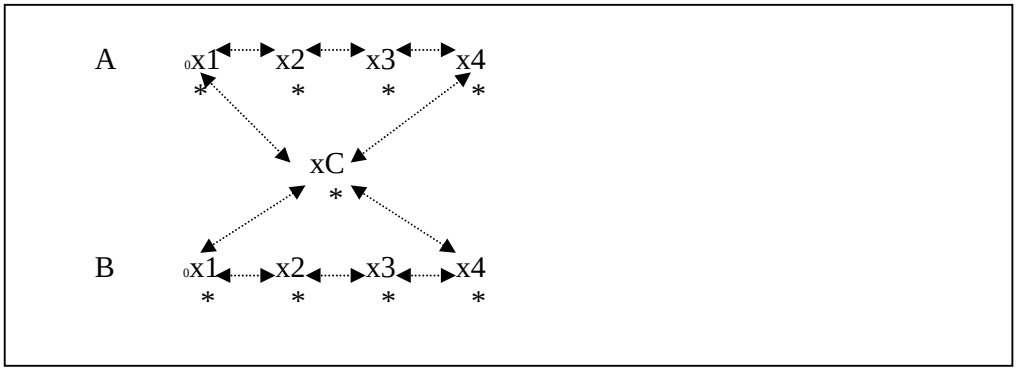
Group: 5 of 3 **Balls:** 2 or 10 **Cones:** 4



The players on the outside each have a ball. They pass to the middle player who catches and passes back immediately before receiving the next pass.
Coaching Tip: Try and get the middle player to catch and pass in two steps. You can change the difficulty level by going from jogging to ¾ and then full sprint.

Drill 14: Middle Man

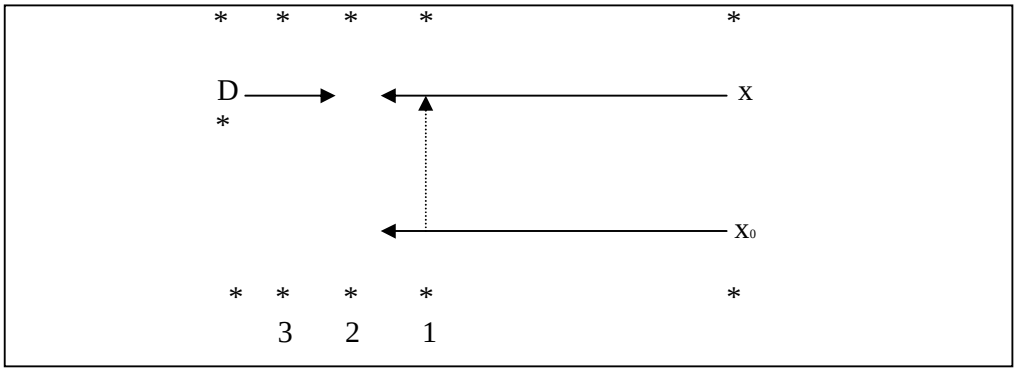
Group: 5 of 3 **Balls:** 2 **Cones:** 9



Ax1 passes the ball to xC. xC passes the ball back to Ax1. Bx1 passes the other ball to xC. xC passes back to Bx1. While this is happening x1 is passing to x2 etc. until x4 gets the ball that will be passed to xC who will return it. The process is then repeated.
Coaching Tip: The middle player has to be awake because the other ball from Bx4 will come quickly.

Drill 15: Intercept Drill

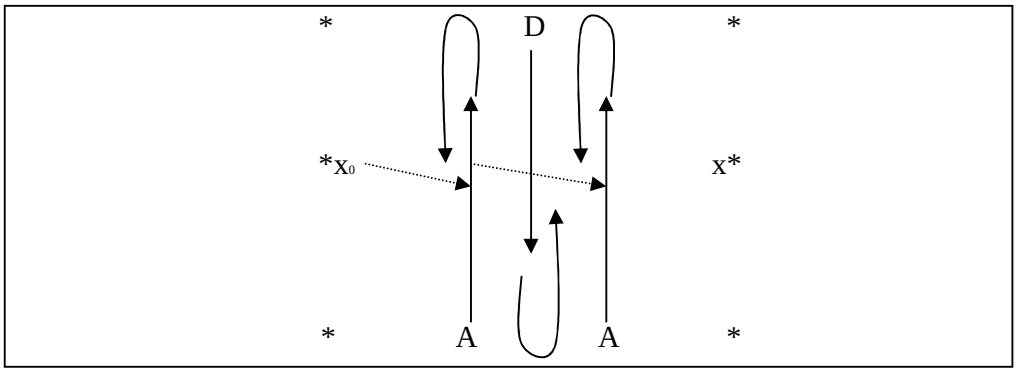
Group: 1of 3 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 10



The defender (D) only moves forward when x_0 gets to the first cone (Change for higher difficulty). When x_0 gets to the first cone he passes to x.

Drill 16: Drawing the man (2 on 1)

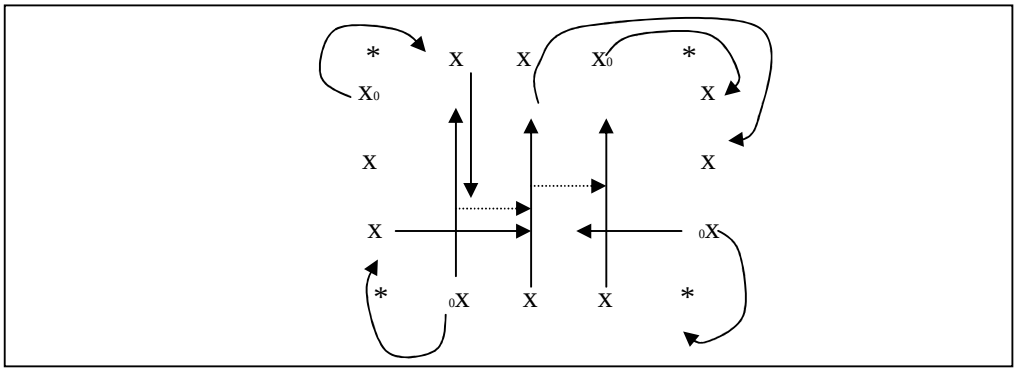
Group: 1 of 5 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 6



Attackers (A) draw the Defender (D) and pass after receiving the ball from player x_0.
The last Attacker receiving the ball passes to x.
Once the players have reached the other end they turn around and repeat.
Coaching Tip: Watch for passing technique i.e. smooth and no jerking.

Drill 17: Traffic Pass with Rotation

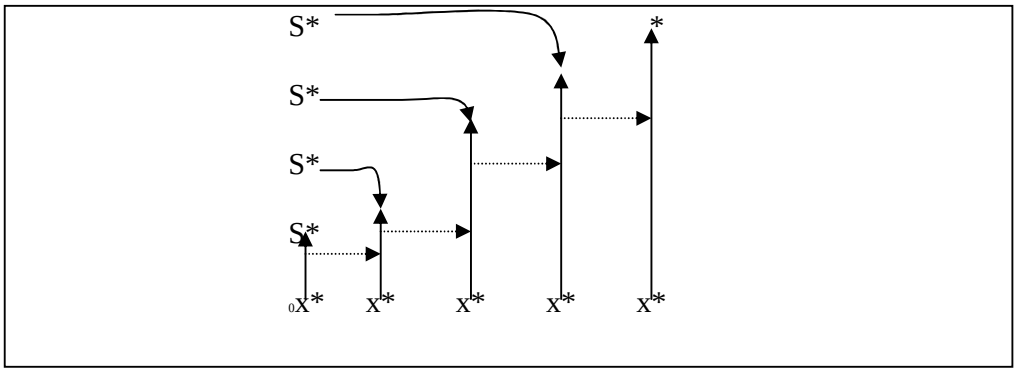
Group: 4 of 3 **Balls:** 4 **Cones:** 4



There are four groups. Start with a ball in each group on the left. Groups run through the grid while passing the ball down the line. The last player places the ball on the ground. The groups rotate to the left and repeat the exercise.
Coaching Tip: Players must focus on acceleration and communication.

Drill 18: Peels

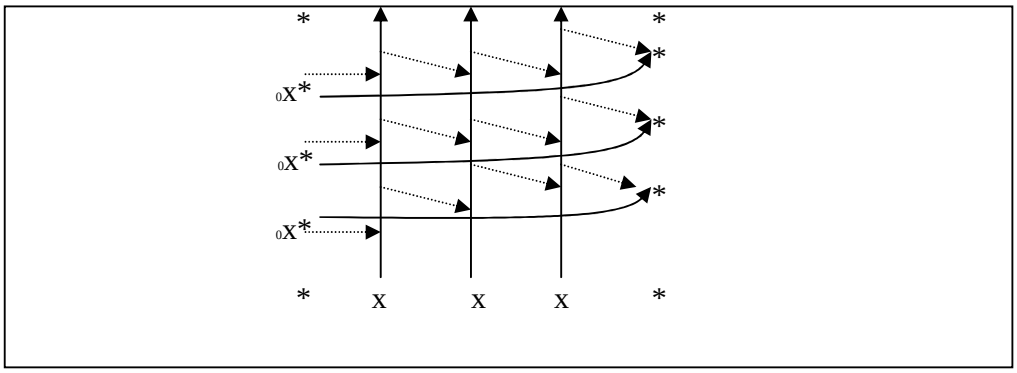
Group: 1 of 9 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 10



The attacking players attack the space, by drawing the defenders (holding shields) and put the outside player away.
Coaching Tip: Attacking players must run straight.
Variation: Defenders can lose the shields and tackle.

Drill 19: Pass and Support

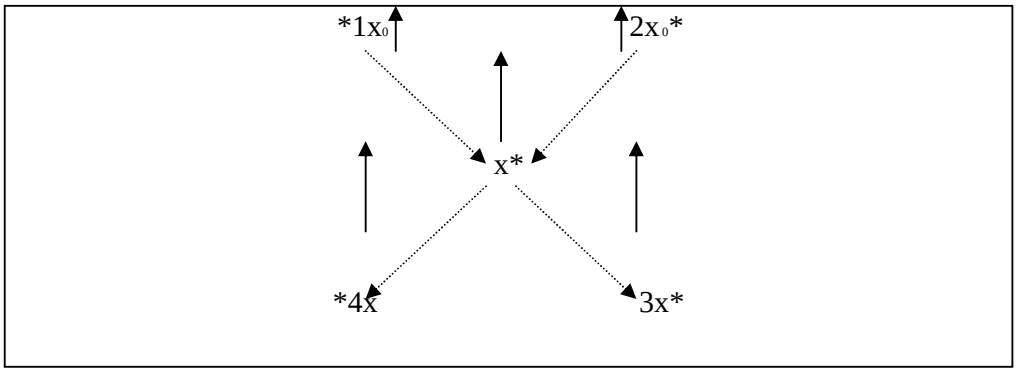
Group: 1 of 6 **Balls:** 3 **Cones:** 10



Attacking players attack the space and receive the ball from the players on the cones who then loop around in support, while the ball is passed down the line. The same exercise is then repeated back down.

Drill 20: Diamond Pass

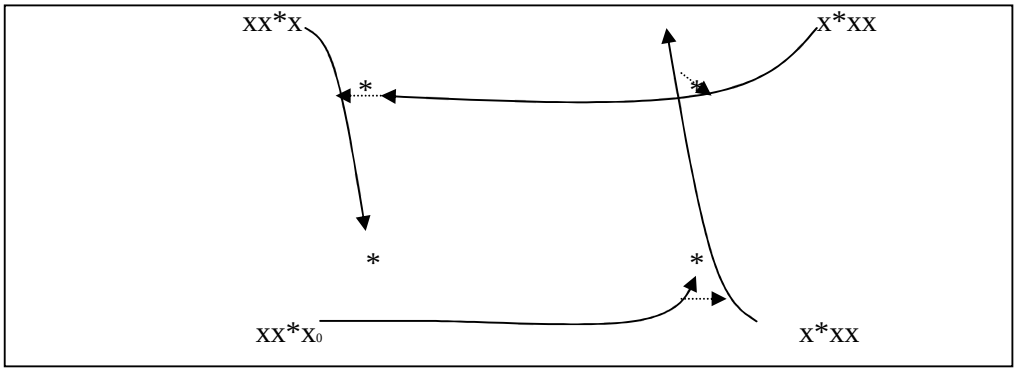
Group: 1 of 5 **Balls:** 2 **Cones:** 5



1x0 passes to x who passes to 3x. 2x0 then passes his ball to x who then passes to 4x. 3x passes the ball to 2x and 4x passes the ball to 1x. (Repeat)
Variation: Players perform the same exercise but while running.
Coaching Tip: Emphasize rhythm, soft hands (relaxed).

Drill 21: Two square Combo

Group: 1 of 15 **Balls:** 1 **Cones:** 8



The drill starts with the player in possession running across the grid towards the inner cone. At the inner cone the player from the other group receives a flat pass. That player then runs to the next inner grid where he does a scissors. That player then performs a flat pass at the other inner cone etc.
Coaching Tip: Watch out for forward passes. Make sure that the player running off on the angle can see the ball at all times i.e. player running off from the right - the pop must be off the right hip. Communication is vital.